ARES CONSORTIUM

Month 8 Review and Recovery Plan

Solis

THARSIS

Meridian

helix

Project Status

Four things have gone wrong at month 8. None of them is a failure of effort. They are four views of one missing artifact.

An exchange is two months late, in the wrong format.
Cadence, latency and encoding were never contract terms. An exchange cannot be late against a deadline nobody set.

Two partners dispute what variables mean and who owns them.
The variables have no declared owner, so the partner that needed names invented them and built against them.

The risk laboratory says the interface cannot carry its claims.
It has no uncertainty clause. A missing clause, not a complaint about quality.

Nobody has shown the coupling is necessary.
The operators bridging hourly simulation to multi-year planning are owned by no one.

Second-year funding depends on a demonstration. This is a crisis to stabilise, not a programme to improve.

Ownership Gap

Five objects the models must exchange, that no partner produces. Of six possible partner pairs, two have any stated exchange at all.

1. The aggregation operator.
Turns Tharsis's hourly demand into the bound Solis plans against. Nobody owns it.

2. The derate function.
Turns Solis's installed capacity into the available capacity Tharsis needs. Tharsis invents its own.

3. The service thresholds and stress scenarios.
Meridian produces both and routes them to nobody.

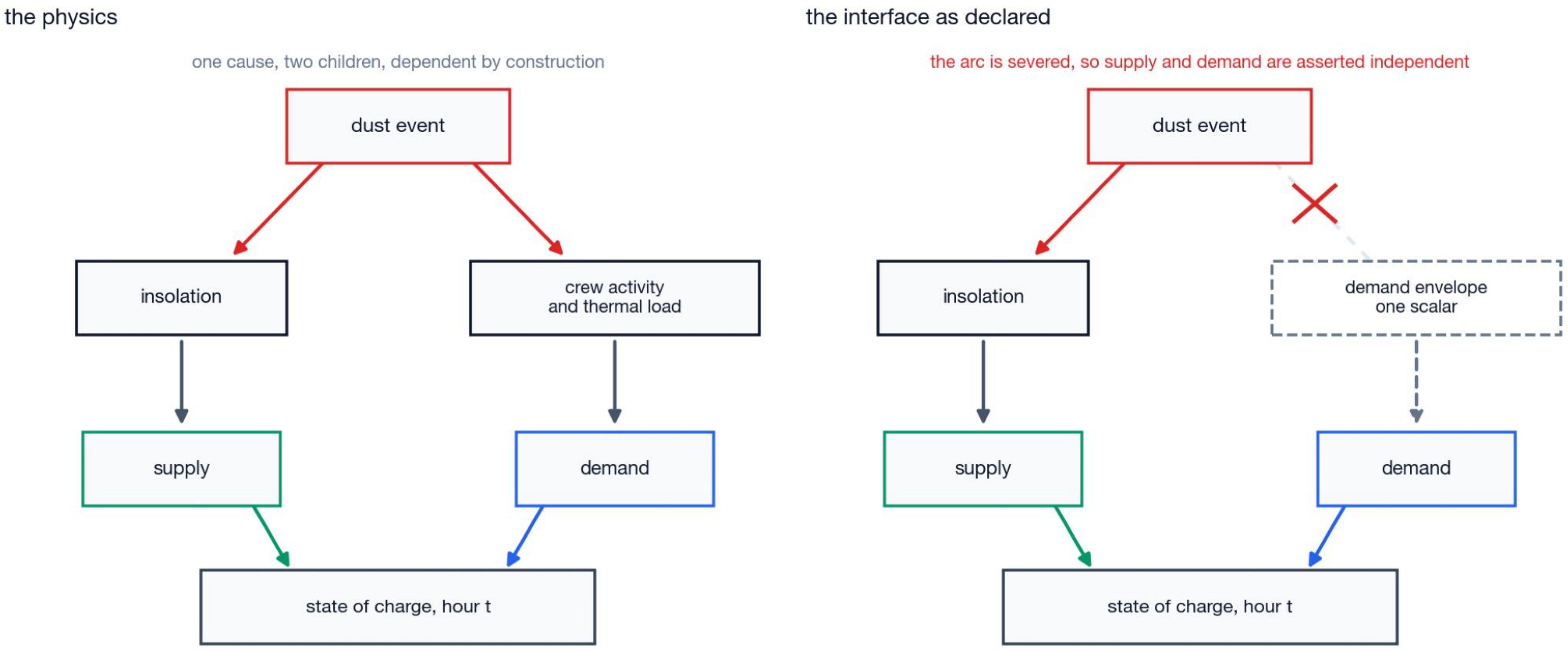
4. The population schedule.
Drives every demand profile. No partner produces it and nobody versions it.

5. The load taxonomy.
Which loads can be shed in a storm and which cannot. Undeclared.

Solid where an exchange has an owner on both sides. Broken where it does not.

Model Fidelity

At what fidelity does this model become admissible evidence for a design decision that kills people if it is wrong? That is the question, not whether coupling is scientifically interesting.



Meridian, clause 4.2: where two stressors share a physical cause, the model shall not treat them as independent.

Somebody signs a habitat design on this.
Below a fidelity floor the model is inadmissible as

No engineer signs on a tool its own authors would not trust.

The physics agrees.
A dust event cuts generation and drives crew indoors at

Delivery Approach

From week 2 the demonstration runs. Every week after improves it rather than building toward a first one.

Week 2 runs end to end on crude inputs.
One sol, nothing polished. Every format mismatch fails

Month 8, and it has never run end to end.
A late exchange in the wrong format is what that

Each week is a superset of the last.
Worst case in week 6 is week 5's version.

Six Week Plan

Solis to Tharsis is the critical path. Meridian runs alongside it. Week 5 absorbs a slip and week 6 rehearses.

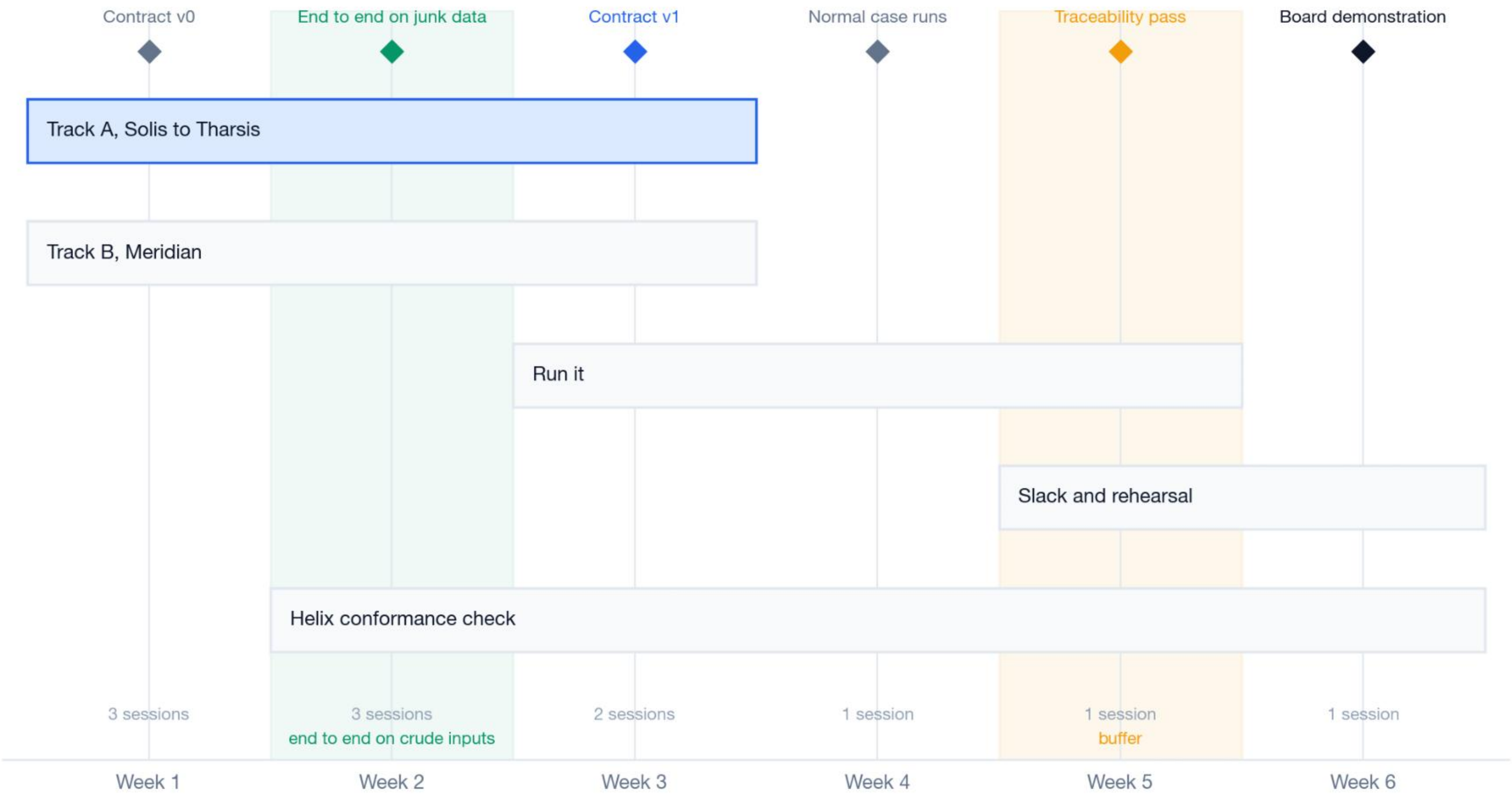
Track A
is the critical path. The exchange that already failed.

Track B
runs alongside, not after. Serialised, the contract gets agreed twice.

Weeks 3 and 4.
Normal case, then the stress event, iterated.

Week 6.
The traceability pass, which is the deliverable.

Every action closes a named gap.



Governance

Eleven sessions in six weeks. Being present and holding the ruling are different things, and the difference is the governance.

Filled where the partner is in the room. A dot marks who holds the ruling. Shaded columns settle what a variable means or who owns it.

Five of the eleven fall in weeks 1 and 2
including the derate session, the expensive decision in the plan.

Two to three touchpoints a week
for the coordinator.

Helix is in seven rooms and holds no rulings.
Present when the contract it built against is settled, never holding the decision.

It holds the only working transport code for the failed exchange. The plan gains if that helps and loses nothing

Partner Alignment

Every partner is worse off under the status quo, and three do not yet know how.

Helix
built against a provisional reading. A declared contract is the only outcome where that work survives. Approach first.

Meridian
has already asked for the uncertainty clause, in the form of an objection. Agree with it in public.

Solis
is judged on a derate function it never saw. Declaring its units is how it takes back control of how its own design is evaluated.

Tharsis
carries blame for thresholds it was never sent and a schedule nobody owns. Declaring the routes moves that liability where it belongs.

In an acute crisis partners accept direction they would decline in business as usual, and that window closes when the crisis is declared over. Week 1 uses it.

Decisions Required

Four decisions and what they buy. Only one of the four costs you anything.

Endorse the diagnosis.
One missing artifact, not four problems. That changes what the next six weeks are for, and it is the decision everything else follows from.

Back the sequence.
Solis to Tharsis first, Meridian alongside it, nothing else started until that exchange works. Saying yes to this means saying no to parallel workstreams that would feel like progress.

Give the coordinator standing to require a declaration.
Units, calendars, owners and what crosses each boundary. Not methods, not code, not anybody's intellectual property. What a partner publishes, not how it computes it.

Accept a narrow demonstration.
One configuration, one stress event, fully traceable. Not a platform, and not four couplings. This is the decision that costs you something, and it is the one that makes week six real.

In return, at week six.
One configuration under a normal case and a material stress event, every number traceable to the model, contract, schedule version and threshold set that produced it. And a test in week five that could tell you this recommendation was wrong.